

Labour Force Survey has an update. It's a welcome one

India's Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation has **unveiled** a new and improved version of the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) and, with that, started providing timely data on the **state** of the labour market. The PLFS was launched in 2017 as an annual survey to replace the **quinquennial** Employment-Unemployment Surveys. Up until now, apart from the annual picture of India's unemployment, PLFS would provide a quarterly update, but only for urban areas. Last week, the MoSPI shared the first-ever monthly PLFS data — for April. Shifting to a monthly reporting cycle promises a **salutary** effect on policy **evaluation**. In the past, timely official data was **scarce** — to find out the impact on unemployment of, say, a pandemic-induced lockdown or a **disruption** like **demonetisation**. Some private **agencies**, such as the CMIE, **have** long been providing monthly, and even weekly, data, but such data has been challenged.

The PLFS has been **revamped** beyond just improving its frequency. For one, the sample design has been improved and the sample size **enlarged**. **The sample size** for each round of survey **will** now be 2,72,304 households — a 2.65 times increase in sample households to be covered in the PLFS compared to the number of sample households covered up to December 2024. The district has been made the primary geographical unit — to ensure sample observations from most of the districts in the PLFS sample, which, in turn, will improve the **representativeness** of the estimates. Also, **notably**, the annual reporting period has been **aligned to** the calendar year, beginning with January 2025 instead of July-June. This shift will enable timely updation of India's labour market **statistics** in the databases maintained by the international agencies.

These **changes** in the PLFS's **methodology** and frequency **are** welcome. As India's economy grows and **seeks** global investors, **credible** and timely data will be **non-negotiable**. The current **data** on the Indian labour market **leaves** a lot to be desired. **For instance**, according to the April data, while the overall unemployment rate in India is 5.1 per cent, it rises to 6.5 per cent when one looks at urban areas, and to 8.7 per cent when one looks at female unemployment in urban areas. The most **worrisome** news **pertains to** youth (15-29 years) unemployment, which stands at 13.8 per cent all-India, rises to 17.2 per cent in urban areas, and further to 23.7 per cent for young urban women. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denote 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Unveil** (verb) – reveal, disclose, launch, present, announce प्रस्तुत करना
2. **State** (noun) – condition, situation, status, shape, circumstance स्थिति
3. **Quinquennial** (adjective) – five-yearly, recurring every five years, half-decade cycle, periodic, scheduled पंचवर्षीय
4. **Salutary** (adjective) – beneficial, helpful, constructive, advantageous, useful लाभदायक / हितकारी
5. **Evaluation** (noun) – assessment, analysis, appraisal, review, judgment मूल्यांकन
6. **Scarce** (adjective) – rare, limited, insufficient, meager, inadequate अपर्याप्त
7. **Disruption** (noun) – disturbance, interruption, disorder, upheaval, breakdown बाधा
8. **Demonetisation** (noun) – currency invalidation, withdrawal of currency, monetary reform, note ban, financial overhaul विमुद्रीकरण
9. **Revamp** (verb) – renovate, reform, overhaul, update, restructure पुनर्गठन करना
10. **Enlarged** (adjective) – expanded, extended, increased, broadened, magnified विस्तारित / बड़ा किया गया
11. **Representativeness** (noun) – typicality, inclusiveness, sample accuracy, generalizability, fairness प्रतिनिधित्वशीलता
12. **Notably** (adverb) – especially, particularly, significantly, importantly, prominently विशेष रूप से
13. **Align** (to) (verb) – adjust, match, coordinate, bring in line, conform मेल बैठाना
14. **Statistics** (noun) – data, figures, metrics, numerical information, records आँकड़े
15. **Methodology** (noun) – procedure, approach, technique, system, process कार्यप्रणाली
16. **Seek** (verb) – pursue, aim for, strive, request, search प्रयास करना
17. **Credible** (adjective) – reliable, trustworthy, dependable, believable, authentic विश्वसनीय
18. **Non-negotiable** (adjective) – fixed, uncompromising, definite, mandatory, unalterable अपरिवर्तनीय
19. **For instance** (phrase) – for example, such as, like, as an illustration, to illustrate उदाहरण के लिए
20. **Worrisome** (adjective) – troubling, concerning, alarming, disturbing, distressing चिंताजनक

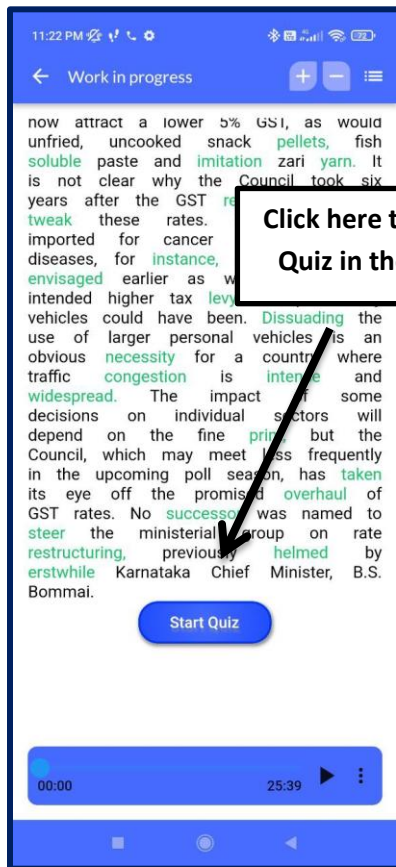
21. **Pertain** (to) (verb) – relate to, be relevant to, concern, apply to, refer संबंधित होना

@mocks_wallah

Summary of the Editorial

1. India's **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** has upgraded the **Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)**.
2. The PLFS, started in **2017**, replaced older Employment-Unemployment Surveys with an annual format.
3. Previously, PLFS gave **quarterly updates** only for **urban areas**, limiting timely insights.
4. In a major shift, MoSPI has now released **monthly PLFS data**, starting with **April 2025**.
5. This change enhances **real-time assessment** of labour market conditions, enabling better **policy evaluation**.
6. In the past, the lack of timely government data made it hard to measure effects of major disruptions (e.g., **lockdowns, demonetisation**).
7. While private agencies like **CMIE** provided frequent data, it was often **disputed** due to methodological concerns.
8. The **revamped PLFS** now includes a **larger sample size** — 2.65 times more households than earlier (now 2,72,304 households).
9. The **district** has been made the **primary geographical unit**, improving **representativeness** across India.
10. The **reporting period** is now aligned to the **calendar year** (starting Jan 2025), aiding **international comparability**.
11. These changes enhance the **credibility and utility** of India's labour statistics, critical for **investors and policymakers**.
12. The **April 2025 data** shows a **national unemployment rate** of **5.1%**.
13. **Urban unemployment** is higher at **6.5%**, with **female urban unemployment** even worse at **8.7%**.
14. **Youth unemployment (ages 15–29)** is alarming: **13.8%** nationally, **17.2%** in urban areas, and **23.7%** among young urban women.
15. Overall, the update is a **welcome step** toward data transparency and better **labour market governance** in India.

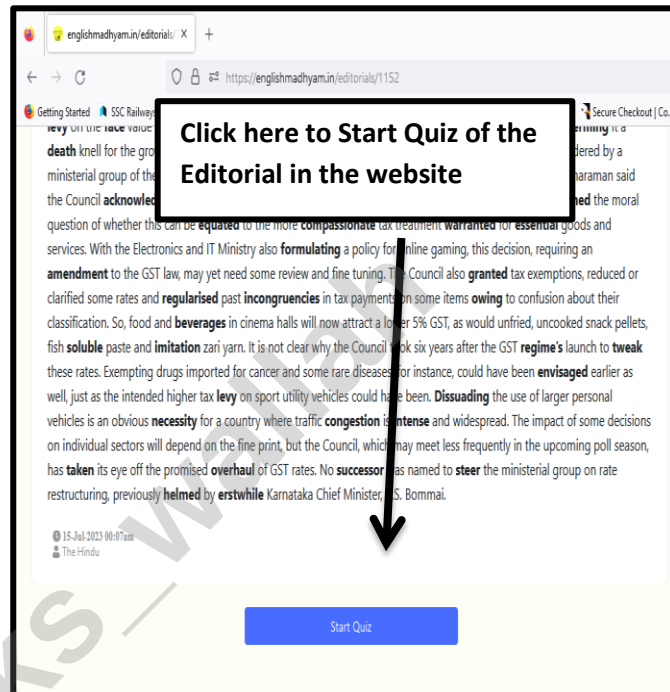
Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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